

problem occurs. Sometimes, in a large environment where the nodes of the clusters are far apart, the Heartbeat link typically stays alive, and so the cluster thinks that it is functioning in a proper manner. Due to the failure of a switch or router to which the primary node is connected, the resource on the cluster as a whole will not be available to users. In such cases, if you have configured *ipfail* in your cluster, then Heartbeat on all nodes can continuously monitor whether they can reach one of the resources on the network (typically, a switch or router). This resource should not be a member of the cluster. If Heartbeat detects *ping* failures then it can directly go and query if the other node has also detected the failures. If the other node reports that the connectivity is okay, then the services are failed back to that node.

Path to better redundancy

So over the last two articles, we have configured a load-balanced, highly-available cluster of Web servers. There are still many shortcomings in achieving the redundancy for a Web infrastructure. One of these issues is the data centre redundancy. In the next article in this series, we will be looking at setting up a redundant data centre for this environment, as well as at networking set-ups like DNS and firewalls, and the positioning of various components. 

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By: Ajitabh Pandey

The author has more than 13 years of diversified IT industry experience in training, support and consulting. You can know more about him at ajitabhpandey@at ajitabhpandey [dot] info

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